

# LOOPS.IE - Authenticated Experience Audit

Signed-in User Experience

Date: 14 March 2026 | Account: anthony@roadmancycling.com (Google OAuth)

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## Executive Summary

The authenticated experience on loops.ie has been substantially rebuilt. Route detail pages are feature-rich (weather, elevation profiles, direction arrows, GPX/Strava/Komoot export, trail conditions, comments). The upload flow supports both file upload and URL import. However, a **critical first-impression bug** means new users see zero routes on sign-in due to geolocation-based filtering, and several other issues undermine discoverability and polish.

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## CRITICAL - Fix Immediately

### 1. New users see 0 routes on first sign-in

#### CRITICAL - CONVERSION KILLER

**Impact:** A new user signs in, scrolls to the explore section, and sees 'No loops match your filters' with an empty map centred on their geolocation. For anyone not physically near your routes (Ireland/Spain), the app appears completely empty. This is the single biggest conversion killer.

**Root cause:** The default sort is 'Nearby / Best rated' which filters routes by map viewport. The map geolocates the user's browser. Since all 19 routes are in Ireland and Cataluna, any user outside those regions sees nothing. Changing to 'Top Rated' immediately shows 10 routes.

#### Steps to fix:

- Change the default sort from 'Nearby/Default' to 'Top Rated' or 'Newest'
- Alternatively, disable map-viewport filtering on the default view
- If keeping 'Nearby', fall back to 'Top Rated' when 0 routes are in the viewport
- Consider showing a world map view initially instead of geolocated view

### 2. Stats counter says '19 ROUTES' but only 10 shown

#### CRITICAL

When sorted by 'Top Rated', only 10 routes appear. No 'Load more' button or pagination. The remaining 9 are hidden, creating a credibility gap.

**Fix:** Add pagination or infinite scroll. Or adjust the stats counter to reflect visible routes.

### 3. Search does not work

#### CRITICAL

Typing 'Girona' in the search bar and pressing Enter does not filter results, show autocomplete, or provide any feedback. The search bar is non-functional.

**Fix:** Implement search-as-you-type with autocomplete. On submit, filter routes and pan the map.

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## **HIGH PRIORITY - Fix This Week**

### **4. /explore returns 404 page**

#### **HIGH**

Navigating to /explore shows a 404 page saying 'This loop doesn't exist - yet.' The explore functionality lives on the homepage (scroll past hero), but there's no dedicated URL. The 404 message is also confusing.

### **5. 'EXPLORE LOOPS' hero button doesn't scroll**

#### **HIGH**

The primary CTA on the authenticated homepage does nothing visible when clicked. Users click it and nothing happens.

### **6. Import URL helper text inconsistency**

#### **HIGH**

The URL input placeholder says 'https://www.strava.com/activities/...' but the helper text says 'Paste a RideWithGPS route URL to import directly.' These mention different services.

### **7. Map tile loading failures**

#### **HIGH**

Grey squares appear on the map where tiles fail to load. Add tile loading error handling with retry logic.

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## **MEDIUM PRIORITY - Fix Before Next Release**

### **8. No user profile page or settings**

The nav shows a profile avatar and 'Sign out' but no profile page or settings. Users cannot view their uploads, ratings, or manage their account.

### **9. No way to navigate back preserving filter state**

The route detail page's back button navigates to the homepage top, losing the user's filter/sort/scroll position.

### **10. Privacy and Terms pages only accessible when logged in**

These redirect to /login for unauthenticated users. Legal compliance issue - must be publicly accessible.

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## What's Working Well

- **Route Detail Pages** - Interactive Leaflet map, current weather (temp, wind, rain, humidity), route stats, difficulty/verified badges, star ratings, elevation profile, key climbs, direction arrows, 'Invite a friend to ride' (WhatsApp CTA), GPX download, Open in Strava/Komoot, copy link, trail conditions, photo upload, and discussion/comments. Genuinely competitive feature set.
- **Upload Flow** - Clean two-tab design (file upload vs URL import). Supports .gpx, .fit, and .tcx. Discipline selector (Gravel/Road/MTB), country/region, difficulty, surface dropdowns.
- **Filter System** - Type tabs (ALL/ROAD/GRAVEL/MTB) with URL query params. Sort dropdown (Default/Nearest/Top Rated/Longest/Newest). Time-based filters (1h/2h/3h/4h+) are unique.
- **Route Cards** - Mini route shape preview (SVG of GPS trace), surface/difficulty badges, name, description, stats, region, and uploader with rating. Information-dense without being cluttered.
- **Map Integration** - Multiple route polylines in different colors. Direction arrows feature is unique. Leaflet + CARTO/OSM integration renders well.

## Full Page Inventory

| Page/URL          | Status     | Notes                                 |
|-------------------|------------|---------------------------------------|
| / (authenticated) | Works      | Hero + explore section on single page |
| /login            | Works      | Public landing page                   |
| /explore          | 404        | Returns "This loop doesn't exist"     |
| /routes/{uuid}    | Works      | Feature-rich route detail page        |
| /upload           | Works      | File upload + URL import form         |
| /about            | Works      | Simple about page                     |
| /privacy          | Auth only  | Needs to be public                    |
| /terms            | Auth only  | Needs to be public                    |
| /feedback         | Not tested | Listed in footer                      |
| Profile/Settings  | Missing    | Does not exist                        |

## Priority Fix Order for Claude Code

1. Default sort showing 0 routes - Change default so all users see routes on first load
2. Search functionality - Wire up the search bar with autocomplete
3. /explore 404 - Create proper /explore route or redirect to homepage#explore
4. 'Explore Loops' button scroll - Make the hero CTA smooth-scroll to explore section
5. Pagination - Add 'Load more' or infinite scroll for all 19 routes
6. Public /privacy and /terms - Add to auth whitelist
7. Import URL helper text - Fix Strava/RideWithGPS copy inconsistency
8. 404 page copy - Change 'This loop doesn't exist' to 'Page not found'
9. Map tile error handling - Add retry logic for failed tile loads

**10.** Back navigation - Preserve filter state when returning from route detail